

- If you are saving the document for printing using Photoshop itself, you can simply save your work as a .psd, which is Photoshop's native format.
- Set your dpi to 300 or more depending on your printer's dpi ability. This has been covered in chapter 2.

9.5 Saving for Web - using web colours

Saving for the web traditionally means using limited number colours (256) as opposed to all the composite colours of the image. This was because not all display cards of earlier days could display more than 256 colours. If a higher bit depth image is forced on a lower bit depth display card, the image would appear distorted. Thus came the idea of using ~safe colours~ for the web so that all users, irrespective of their hardware could view the image properly. Later on, even after higher capacity display cards came into vogue, the 8 bit (256 colour) scheme was retained in order to reduce the file size. Besides, web images are not meant for printing. Hence it still makes sense to reduce many non-real images, if not all to a 256 (or even lower) colour scheme.

Access the ~Save for Web~ option under the File menu. You can choose from the presets available or make your own. Click on the ~Optimized~ tab to see the image as you apply changes to it, or ~2 Up~ to compare the optimised image with the original and. At the bottom of the image you will see the file size and the settings. Try out the different settings available and see which one suits you best. Different options are available for different file types. Use GIF / PNG or JPEG according to the nature of the image as we have discussed in the previous sections.

If you click on the ~4 Up~ tab, you can see the original image along with three variations of it. You can use this to compare how the different settings make your images look. Once you have finalised your settings click on ~Save~. If you want a HTML file to be created with the image tag placed in it, choose to save the file as ~HTML with Images~. If you just want the image and don't need the HTML file, just choose ~Images only~.